- **Maintain Blood Sugar Level:** The fiber content in cereals decreases the speed of glucose secretion from the food, thereby maintaining sugar levels in the blood.
- **Provide Protein:** Cereals usually have 6-12% protein.
- **Source of Vitamins:** Cereals are a good source of vitamins B.

2.10 Pulses

Pulses are edible fruits or seeds of pod bearing plants. Pulses are the edible seeds of plants in the legume family. Pulses grow in pods and come in a variety of shapes, sizes and colors. Different varieties of pulses are grown around the globe. The major pulses or dhals which find important place in Indian diet are red gram dhal, Bengal gram dhal, black gram dhal and green gram dhal. Some pulses like Bengal gram, green gram, rajmah, soya bean dry peas are used as whole grams. A legume is a plant or its fruit or seed. Well known legumes include chickpeas, channa and soyabean.

ACTIVITY - 2

List any five recipes that can be made out of:
(a) Rice (b) Wheat (c) Ragi (d) Semolina (e) Millets and their preparation.

The word pulse originates directly from the Latin *puls* meaning "thick gruel or porridge".

2.10. 1 Nutritive value of pulses

Pulses give 340 calories per 100 grams which is almost similar to cereal calorie value. Pulses contain 55 to 60 percent starch. In a vegetarian diet, pulses are important sources of protein. They give about 20-25 percent protein that is double the amount of protein compared to cereals. The proteins present in pulses are not of good quality as they are deficient in aminoacids. Pulses contain 1.5 percent fats. They contain calcium, magnesium, zinc, iron, potassium



Pulses

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